

AFL Data Dictionary + Target Definitions

Dataset Overview

The AFL dataset covers **1983–2025** and contains player, match, and seasonal performance data.

Dataset	Grain	Purpose
afl_players_info_raw.csv	One row per player	Player identity and biographical information
afl_players_round_by_round_stats_raw.csv	One row per player per match/round	Player match performance
afl_players_seasonal_stats_raw.csv	One row per player per season	Seasonal player performance
team_matches_home_away_raw.csv	One row per team per match	Team results and match information

Coverage: 1983–2025 | **Reconstructed matches:** 7,904 | **Players:** 2,848 | **Player-round records:** 274,089

Target Definitions

Target	Definition	Task
match_winner	Match outcome from the home team’s perspective based on final scores: Home Win, Draw, or Away Win	3-class classification
top_disposal_player	Player with the highest disposals in a match	Player identification
top_goal_kicker	Player with the highest goals in a match	Player identification

Leakage control: Target-match performance values are excluded from predictive features. Ties for top-player targets are flagged rather than assigned arbitrarily. Because historical goal data has substantial non-random missingness, top_goal_kicker is only defined where goal data is sufficiently complete.

Feature Dictionary

Feature	Definition
home_recent_5_win_rate / away_recent_5_win_rate	Team win rate over previous 5 matches

Feature	Definition
home_win_streak / away_win_streak	Consecutive wins entering the match
home_recent_5_avg_score / away_recent_5_avg_score	Average score over previous 5 matches
home_days_rest / away_days_rest	Days since team's previous match
h2h_matches	Number of previous meetings between the teams
h2h_current_home_wins / h2h_current_away_wins	Previous wins by the current home/away team in the matchup
h2h_draws	Previous draws between the teams
h2h_current_home_win_rate	Current home team's historical win rate against opponent
home_pre_match_ladder_rank / away_pre_match_ladder_rank	League-wide ladder position before the match
home_pre_match_points / away_pre_match_points	Accumulated season points before the match
home_pre_match_percentage / away_pre_match_percentage	Score-for/score-against percentage before the match
venue	Match venue
player_recent_5_avg_disposals	Player's average disposals over previous 5 matches

Leakage prevention: All historical rolling, H2H, rest, and ladder features use information available **before the target match**. Current-match results and performance statistics are not used as predictive features.

Versioned outputs: afl_match_features_v1.csv, afl_player_features_v1.csv, afl_feature_dictionary_v1.csv